

ALI KIRAT

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Software Engineer with 3+ years of experience designing, building, and deploying full-stack web applications using the MERN stack (MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js). Experienced in RESTful API development, secure authentication with JWT and bcrypt, scalable database design, and responsive, user-centered UI and UX for production environments. Proven ability to deliver applications end to end, from concept and wireframes through deployment on Netlify, Render, and MongoDB Atlas, with version control and collaboration using Git and GitHub. Strong communicator with a multidisciplinary background in education and project leadership, bringing clear problem-solving skills and familiarity with Agile development practices. Seeking to contribute to high-impact engineering teams building reliable, user-focused software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: JavaScript (ES6+), HTML5, CSS3, Python, PHP

Frontend Development: React, React Hooks, React Router, CSS Modules, Responsive Web Design, Mobile-First Design, UI/UX Design, Wireframing, Cross-Browser Compatibility

Backend Development: Node.js, Express.js, RESTful API Development, API Integration, Server-Side Logic, Middleware, JWT Authentication, bcrypt, Session Management

Database: MongoDB, Mongoose ODM, Database Design, CRUD Operations, Data Modeling, MongoDB Atlas

Development Tools: Git, GitHub, Visual Studio Code, Postman, Chrome DevTools, npm

Deployment & Hosting: Netlify, Render, MongoDB Atlas, Environment Variables, UptimeRobot

Methodologies: Agile Development, Version Control, Code Review, Documentation, Security Best Practices, Debugging, Testing

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Atlas Taxi - Full-Stack Ride Booking Application

Live Demo: atlastaxi.netlify.app

GitHub: github.com/alikirat/frontend-capstone and [backend-capstone](https://github.com/alikirat/backend-capstone)

Technologies: MongoDB, Express.js, React, Node.js, JWT, Axios, bcrypt, CSS Modules

- Built a production-ready ride-booking platform supporting user registration, ride scheduling, admin workflows, and secure data persistence
- Developed 12+ protected REST API endpoints with error-handling middleware and JWT-based authentication using httpOnly cookies
- Integrated MongoDB with relational data models and performance indexing; implemented an admin dashboard with search and sorting features
- Deployed frontend and backend services independently with environment variable management for secure configuration

AI Chatbot – LLM-Powered Web Application

Live Demo: akdev-chatbot.netlify.app

GitHub: github.com/alikirat/chatbot

Technologies: JavaScript, Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, LLM API (Groq), HTML, CSS

- Built an AI-powered chatbot application integrating a large language model (LLM) to generate real-time conversational responses
- Designed a backend service to securely manage API requests, environment variables, and response handling
- Implemented a responsive frontend interface for user input, message rendering, and graceful error states

- Applied prompt design and request structuring techniques to improve response relevance and usability, and deployed the application using Netlify and Render with production-style separation of frontend and backend services

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Software Engineer | Freelance | Los Angeles, CA | Feb 2022 - Present

- Design, develop, and maintain full-stack web applications with a focus on clean, modular architecture and scalable RESTful APIs
- Build secure authentication systems using JWT, bcrypt, protected routes, and role-based access control
- Implement responsive, accessible UI components using React, CSS Modules, React Router, and modern state management patterns
- Manage cloud-based NoSQL databases using MongoDB Atlas and Mongoose, including schema design and query optimization
- Deploy and monitor applications using Netlify, Render, and UptimeRobot to ensure reliability and uptime
- Utilize Git and GitHub for version control, branching strategies, and pull request workflows
- Apply Agile practices such as sprint planning, backlog refinement, and code reviews
- Explore AI-assisted workflows and modern tooling to enhance automation and application functionality

Private Teacher | Self-Employed | Various Locations | Aug 2013 - Sep 2024

- Created personalized curriculum and instruction strategies for K–12 and college-level students across multiple disciplines
- Used educational technology tools to design lessons, track performance, and communicate progress
- Adapted teaching methods to diverse learning styles, demonstrating strong communication and problem-solving skills

Business Consultant | Self-Employed | Los Angeles, CA | Feb 2020 - Dec 2022

CGML - San Diego, CA (Jul 2020 - Jul 2022)

- Led digital fundraising strategy and multimedia outreach, increasing online engagement by 40%
- Managed donor communications, event logistics, and volunteer coordination to meet nonprofit goals

EDUCATION

Per Scholas | Software Engineering | Remote | April 2025

15-week intensive covering full-stack JavaScript, data structures, algorithms, and best practices

Claremont Graduate University | Master of Arts | Claremont, CA

Zaytuna College | Bachelor of Arts | Berkeley, CA

CERTIFICATIONS

AI Agents Intensive | Kaggle & Google | Dec 2025

- Agent workflows, tool use, structured prompting, multi-agent coordination, and evaluation using Gemini and the Agent Developer Kit (ADK)

Frontend Development | Skillcrush | December 2022

Python: Variables, Data Types, and Lists | Dataquest.io | January 2022